

10.3 SECI Model of Knowledge Creation

The SECI model, developed by Nonaka and Takeuchi in 1995, is a framework for understanding how knowledge is created and shared within the organisation. The SECI model illustrates how knowledge is transformed between tacit and explicit forms through the four modes of Socialisation, Externalisation, Combination, and Internalisation.

1. Socialisation

Socialisation is about how tacit knowledge gets shared among people within an organisation. Socialisation happens when employees share their expertise, skills, and insights through daily interactions, working together in the same environment, and informal meetings.

2. Internalisation

Internalisation occurs when explicit knowledge—information that can be easily expressed—is transformed into tacit knowledge, becoming deeply understood and applied in practice. For instance, in training programmes, new employees may read about their roles and the company, but through reflection and practice, this knowledge becomes tacit in their understanding and becomes part of how they operate. This tacit knowledge is not easily communicated but is shown through actions, shared mental models, or technical expertise. Therefore, internalisation is about transforming explicit knowledge into tacit knowledge.

